

## AIRS TO THE FUTURE

**COMPANY** Sumaya HMX Systems | **WHAT THEY DO** Provide Low-cost Conditioning Solutions | **TURNOVER** Rs 10 crore

Looking for an air-conditioning system that saves both power and the atmosphere? Bangalore-based A. Vaidyanathan, founder of a new-age cooling company, Sumaya HMX Systems, may have the answer. Vaidyanathan always believed that there was a market for efficient and low-cost cooling in India. So in 1998, he set up Sumaya, offering a cooling method that claims to significantly lower costs. Unlike normal air-conditioning, Sumaya's ambiators work on the principle of cooling ambient air in two stages. This innovative new comfort-conditioning system uses up to 60 per cent less power than traditional models and works without the use of chlorofluorocarbons which emit greenhouse gases into the atmosphere.

With the developed countries having committed to reducing their carbon footprint, the green and efficient cooling technology is finding acceptance in large corporates like NIIT, Wipro and Honeywell. While a conventional air-conditioning unit used for a small office will emit 62 kg of carbon dioxide a year, units produced by Sumaya could cut emission levels by up to a third. Though Vaidyanathan is on the right track, he is yet to achieve the economies of scale that would put his company in the big league.

SANJAY RAMCHANDRAN / www.indiatodayimages.com



**A. VAIDYANATHAN**

**SUMAYA'S INNOVATIVE AIR-CONDITIONING SYSTEM USES UP TO 60 PER CENT LESS POWER.**

## FIELDS OF GOLD

**COMPANY** Nandan Biomatrix | **WHAT THEY DO** Produce Biofuels | **TURNOVER** Rs 70 crore

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**C.S. JADHAV (RIGHT)**



Starting out as a company trying to market medicinal herbs in 1996, Nandan Biomatrix today wants to nurture all things green. While its nutraceuticals division focuses on high-value medicinal plants for commercial cultivation and bulk extraction, the relatively new division on green fuels is looking to straddle the entire value chain of biofuels. The company currently has 40,000 hectares under jatropha cultivation and is targeting about 90,000 hectares by the end of this year through active contract farming.

So how does Nandan hopes to make money from its bio-fuels division? The company is looking at a multi-pronged strategy for this. And in order to make it a cash-neutral business for the farmer, C.S. Jadhav, marketing director at Nandan Biomatrix, says: "Our franchisee will provide all the help the farmer needs to grow this new crop. And on maturity, we will buy back the crop from the farmers." However, India currently faces a crisis in terms of collecting adequate feedstock as not many farmers are growing non-edible oil yielding plants. Till such time more plant oil comes on stream, the bio-diesel business may not be able to look forward to a very green harvest.